



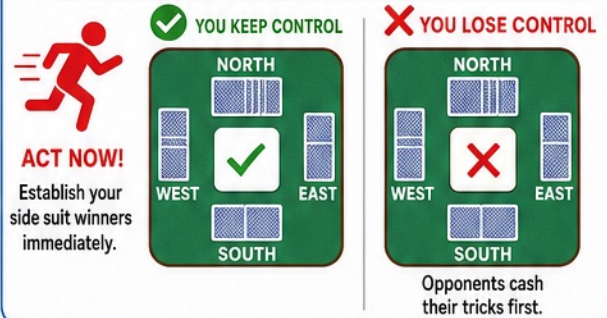
FIGB

Lesson 3: Trump Contracts - Timing and Control

1 DISCARD ON SIDE WINNERS: do it **BEFORE** drawing trumps!



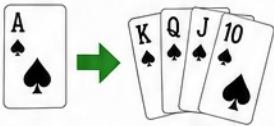
2 **URGENCY** to establish the side suit: if you don't do it immediately, you **lose control**



3 **LEGITIMATE** vs **ILLEGITIMATE TRUMP**

LEGITIMATE TRUMP

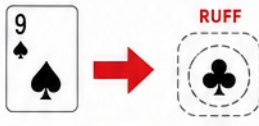
Trump played to draw opponents' trumps.



✓ Purpose: take away the opponents' trumps.

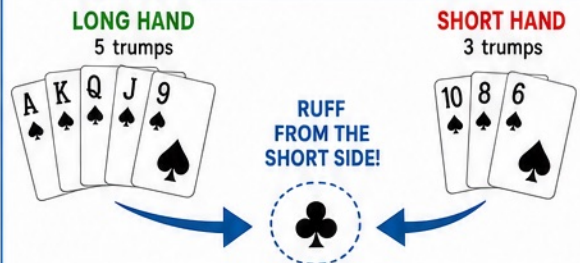
ILLEGITIMATE TRUMP

Trump used for a ruff (extra trick).



✗ Purpose: not to draw trumps, but to ruff.

4 **RUFF FROM THE SHORT SIDE:** only this way you gain extra tricks



★ Ruff from the short side = extra trick!

5 **THE 4-4 FIT:** the most powerful in bridge!



WHY?

Both hands can ruff in the other suit.
This generates more tricks.

4-4 FIT
BOTH HANDS
CAN RUFF



5-3 FIT
ONLY ONE HAND
CAN RUFF



4-4 FIT GENERATES MORE TRICKS THAN A 5-3 FIT!



6 **SCHEME: FIRST DISCARD, THEN DRAW TRUMPS, THEN CASH**

1 FIRST DISCARD

Discard losers on your side suit winners.



2 THEN DRAW TRUMPS

Draw all the opponents' trumps.



3 THEN CASH

Cash your winners and enjoy your tricks!

